

CYCLONE TICKET REDEMPTION

Free-Play Conversion + Complete Restoration Guide
Step-by-step free-play setup • Mechanics • Reliability for public use

Prepared for **Coin Op 4 Charity** / Arcade Angels
Converting and restoring a classic spinning-light ticket game for youth and community spaces

1. Overview & Goals

Cyclone (and similar spinning-light ticket redemption games) challenge the player to stop a moving light on the skill stop or jackpot segment. They are durable, easy to understand, and work well in youth centers when set to free-play or low cost. This guide covers both a complete restoration path and a clear free-play conversion process for charity and community placements.

2. Safety

- Unplug the machine before any internal work.
- Moving light mechanisms and ticket dispensers can pinch — keep hands clear when testing under power.
- Secure the ticket door and any access panels so they cannot be forced by players.
- Keep the interior free of loose tools or parts before returning the machine to public use.

3. Cabinet Exterior & Presentation

- Clean the entire exterior thoroughly. Remove sticky residue, fingerprints, and dust from the playfield glass, side art, and control area.
- Inspect graphics, decals, and the light ring/playfield. Replace or carefully restore heavily damaged sections so the machine looks inviting.
- Confirm the spinning light effect is bright and even — appearance is a large part of the appeal.
- Level the cabinet so the light travels true and the machine does not rock.

4. Play Mechanism — Light Ring, Sensors & Button

- Clean the playfield glass and the light ring thoroughly. Dust or haze reduces clarity and can affect sensor accuracy.
- Confirm the spinning light (or LED chase) moves smoothly and consistently. Binding or uneven speed usually indicates a dirty motor, worn bushing, or power issue.
- Test the stop button for clean, immediate registration. Replace sticky or unreliable microswitches.
- Verify win detection (skill stop vs. jackpot segments) awards the correct ticket values and does not false-trigger.

5. Ticket Dispenser

- Inspect the ticket dispenser for jams, torn tickets, or misaligned feed. Clean out debris.
- Confirm tickets feed reliably on a win and that the dispenser resets properly.
- Check the ticket path from the roll to the outlet for sharp edges or restrictions that cause tears.
- Keep a spare ticket roll on hand for public placements so the machine does not go empty mid-day.

6. Power, Board & Connections

- Clean the power supply area and verify stable voltages under load.
- Reseat the main board and any light-driver or sensor boards. Clean connectors.
- Inspect motor and dispenser wiring for damage or loose pins.
- Dust the interior thoroughly — heat and dust are the main long-term reliability issues on these machines.

7. Step-by-Step Free-Play Conversion

Exact menu names vary slightly by manufacturer and revision, but the process is similar on most Cyclone-style games:

Step 1 — Access the operator menu

Open the coin door or rear access panel. Locate the operator key switch or the service/test button. Turn the key or press the button to enter the setup / operator menu. (Some units require a specific button combination on the control panel while powered on — check any remaining labels or the manual if available.)

Step 2 — Locate coin / credit settings

Navigate to the section labeled Coins, Credits, Pricing, or Free Play. You should see options for coins per credit, credits per play, or a direct Free Play toggle.

Step 3 — Set free play

Select Free Play (or set coins-per-credit to 0 / free). Confirm and save the setting. Exit the menu cleanly so the change is stored.

Step 4 — Verify

Power-cycle or return to attract mode and confirm a game starts without inserting a coin. Play several rounds to ensure tickets still dispense correctly on wins.

Step 5 — Document

Write down the exact menu path and settings used. Leave a short note inside the coin door or with the machine keys so future volunteers can reverse or adjust the setting if needed.

If the machine has no free-play option in software, some operators use a simple coin-switch jumper or a free-play harness. Only do this if you are comfortable with basic wiring and document the modification clearly.

8. Final Testing Checklist Before Placement

- Full cold boot to attract mode with spinning light and sound working
- Light travels smoothly and stops cleanly on button press
- Skill-stop and jackpot awards dispense the correct ticket values
- Ticket dispenser feeds reliably and does not jam during repeated wins
- No binding, unusual noise, or intermittent sensor failures
- Cabinet exterior is clean, level, and free of sharp edges or loose parts
- Free-play (or approved low pricing) is correctly set and documented
- Keys, spare tickets, spare fuses, and a short instruction sheet bagged and labeled for the host organization

9. Notes for Host Sites

Provide a short one-page sheet: power on/off, free-play status, and who to contact. Recommend a weekly wipe-down of the glass, button, and light ring. Ask the host to report any new sticking, missed stops, or ticket jams early. Document the free-play method used and any non-original parts for future volunteers.

This guide is intended for educational and nonprofit service use by Coin Op 4 Charity and partner organizations. The goal is a Cyclone that stays fair, reliable, and fun for the people who play it.

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